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# The Chromebook query



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One thing about the PC master race is that we consider ourselves superior - and with that comes the implied conclusion that everything else is inferior. Consoles? Macs? It is a generally accepted idea that nothing really measures up to the glory of a full fledged all-component-blazing PC, and everyone should go for it. I have a lot of friends who swear by the PC master race and I am somewhat of a loyalist myself. The thing is, sometimes it can get difficult for anyone to get a point across to some loyalists.

On one Sunday afternoon, in between a few heated CS:GO death-matches, one of my friends told the rest of the group that he had purchased a Chromebook for his freshly graduated kid brother, who is an aspiring automobile-blogger. Of course, what followed immediately was a massive session of hilarious jokes and geeky insults (we all know what I am talking about here, eh?), all targeted at the poor fellow who couldn't really say anything in his defence. But this brief exchange had set some mental cogs into motion and even after the CS:GO session was

over, I couldn't stop thinking about Chromebooks. I had tried one in its initial days and frankly, it wasn't that great. The idea behind it - I liked that part. But mostly it was almost destined to fail, the way it was at that point. In fact, even my reviewer buddies at Digit thought so. Has something changed over this time? This definitely warrants more research.

## Google's computing experiment - the Chrome OS

The initial idea behind Google's ChromeOS felt quite impressive and audacious to me - an entire computing platform that ran nothing but a browser. Wow! Right? Over the years, I have noticed that the majority of us spend most of our computing time on web browser windows. So I had a lot of expectations when Chromebooks hit the stores - a paradigm shift, computing overhaul, etc. - but was disappointed soon enough.

It was after I began my research afresh recently that I came across a few interesting confirmations about certain Chromebook updates - both in terms

of hardware and software - that I was not completely sure of until that point. For starters, there are a lot of them in all shapes and sizes and specifications. While the India availability is sketchy, it would be wrong to deny that there are Chromebooks that satisfy almost every specific requirement need. Hmm, interesting! So what exactly was my friend thinking when he got a Chromebook for his brother?

## Form factor

Well, I am aware since day one of the ChromeOS that it is intended to be lightweight. I can hear you smirking, "Chrome and lightweight?". Well, not if you're a heavy handed multi-tasker like me. But for a major section of consumers, whose only needs are to browse, watch videos and use some apps, say, a 2 GB RAM Chromebook with a mid level Intel Processor would make sense. And due to being light on the specifications, Chromebooks can be built to be extremely portable yet inexpensive at the same time. I mean, would you believe that there is a Chromebook at the price of a mid range smartphone? Turns out there is. That somewhat ticks off one major box making it gift friendly. Someone's getting one!

What else? Hmm, the guy wants to be a blogger, so mostly he would be working on documents, browsing online, maybe upload a few pictures or watch some videos. A Chromebook and Google's suite of cloud based applications are perfect for this use case. Heck, even I could use a Chromebook if that was all I did! But if I remember correctly, that kid brother of my friend was complaining about the spotty internet connection in his hometown the last time we spoke. When offline, Chromebooks were little other than a dead laptop the last time I had laid my hands on them. Somehow, it didn't make sense and at this point I had to verify some-